Era 25: Contemporary Era

2008–present · APUSH Period 9 · Lessons 57–57

Name _____ Due _____

This is your study guide for the whole era. Complete each lesson section as you study it, using your class notes and textbook: read the AP topic(s) listed for the lesson in your textbook, define every term, person and event in your own words, then answer the Key Question in 3–5 sentences with specific evidence. Each lesson is checked and stamped in class; the whole guide is collected and graded at the end of the era. **Before the end-of-era test:** finish the Era Wrap-Up, then reread the whole guide. Fix or add anything in a different color.

Lesson 57 *Great Recession · Obama · Trump · COVID · Biden*

9.6 (LO F): Explain the causes and effects of the domestic and international challenges the United States has faced in the 21st century.

Read (AP topic in your textbook): Topic 9.6 *Challenges of the 21st Century*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

1. **Tea Party movement**

2. **political polarization**

3. **social media & Big Tech**

4. **climate change**

5. **Black Lives Matter**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

6. **Barack Obama**

7. **Donald Trump**

8. **Joe Biden**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

9. **Great Recession & TARP (2008)**

10. **Affordable Care Act (2010)**

11. **Obergefell v. Hodges (2015)**

12. **COVID-19 pandemic (2020)**

13. **Capitol riot (Jan. 6, 2021)**

14. **Russia invades Ukraine (2022)**

Lesson 57 · Key Question *Great Recession · Obama · Trump · COVID · Biden*

9.6 (LO F): Explain the causes and effects of the domestic and international challenges the United States has faced in the 21st century.

Explain how the Great Recession and other domestic and international challenges after 2008 shaped debates over the role of the federal government.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Era Wrap-Up *complete before the end-of-era test*

Challenges Since 2008

Challenge	What happened	Government response	Continuing debate
Great Recession (2007–09)			
Health care (Affordable Care Act, 2010)			
COVID-19 pandemic (2020)			
Russia's invasion of Ukraine (2022)			

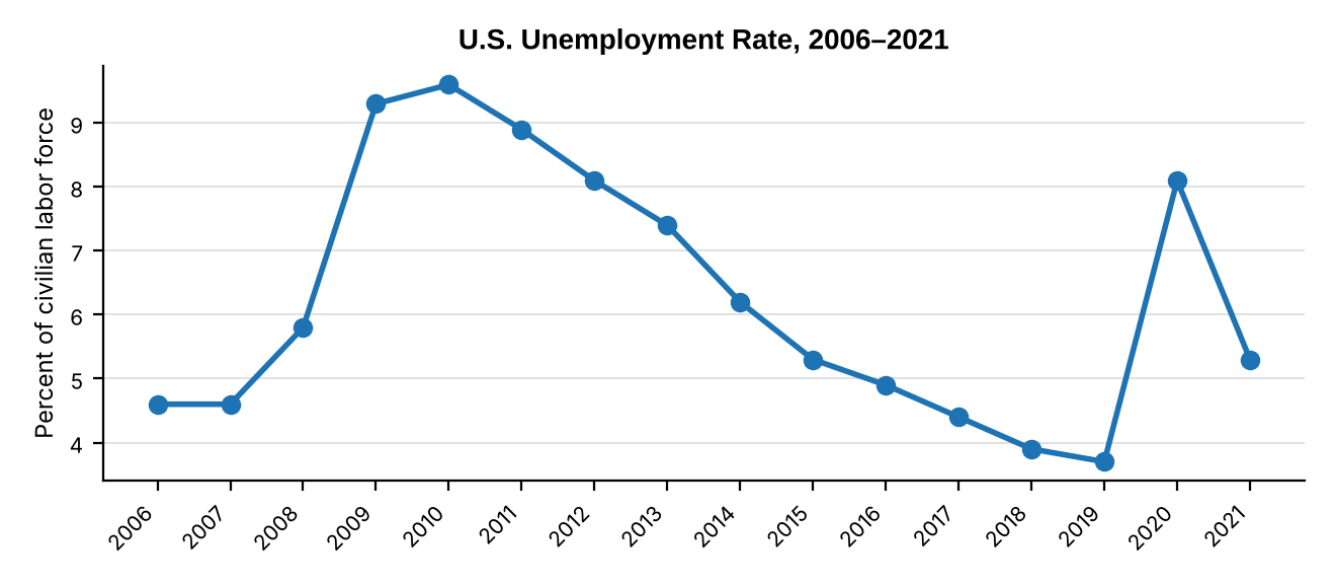
Continuity and Change: Long-Run Themes

Theme	An example from an earlier era	An example since 2008
Role of the federal government		
Expansion of rights		
Migration & immigration		
America's role in the world		

AP Short-Answer Practice

Answer a, b and c. Each part is scored on its own, so answer each one directly in 1–3 sentences with specific historical evidence.

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Current Population Survey, annual average unemployment rate, 2006–2021



Annual averages, civilian labor force 16 years and older.

Data: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Current Population Survey, Table 1 (annual averages).

a. Briefly describe ONE trend in the unemployment rate shown in the chart between 2006 and 2021.

b. Briefly explain ONE cause of the change in unemployment shown in the chart between 2008 and 2010 OR in 2020.

c. Briefly explain ONE way the federal government responded to an economic or public-health challenge between 2008 and 2021.

DBQ Practice · Sourcing: Historical Situation

PROMPT

Evaluate the extent to which the Great Recession shaped debates over the role of the federal government from 2008 to 2016.

Your task: Write 2–3 sentences explaining how the historical situation in which the document on this page was delivered is relevant to an argument that answers the prompt.

What earns the point: To earn credit, explain how or why the document's historical situation (the circumstances when it was created) is relevant to your argument. Simply naming the date or setting is not enough; connect the situation to what the document says and to your claim. On the real DBQ you would do this for at least two documents.

Barack Obama, Inaugural Address, Washington, D.C., January 20, 2009

That we are in the midst of crisis is now well understood. Our Nation is at war against a far-reaching network of violence and hatred. Our economy is badly weakened, a consequence of greed and irresponsibility on the part of some, but also our collective failure to make hard choices and prepare the Nation for a new age. Homes have been lost, jobs shed, businesses shuttered. Our health care is too costly. Our schools fail too many. And each day brings further evidence that the ways we use energy strengthen our adversaries and threaten our planet.

[. . .]

The question we ask today is not whether our Government is too big or too small, but whether it works; whether it helps families find jobs at a decent wage, care they can afford, a retirement that is dignified. Where the answer is yes, we intend to move forward. Where the answer is no, programs will end.

Text: The American Presidency Project, UC Santa Barbara (from Public Papers of the Presidents). Excerpt.

Connect forward — *Looking back: from the Hamilton–Jefferson fight over a national bank to the responses to the Great Recession and COVID-19, Americans have argued about how large and active the federal government should be. Which earlier era's version of that debate do recent debates most resemble?*